

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1518

By Martin G

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Barry Clingan upon his recognition by the East Tennessee Historical Association as a member of the First Families of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, the East Tennessee Historical Association has recognized Barry Clingan as a member of the First Families of Tennessee, an honor reserved for those who can document a direct ancestor present in the region that became Tennessee prior to its admission to the Union in 1796; and

WHEREAS, Barry Clingan traces his proud Scots-Irish heritage to three Clingan brothers who immigrated from Donegal, Ireland, in 1739 with their Presbyterian pastor and settled in Donegal, Pennsylvania; and

WHEREAS, one of these brothers was the father of William Clingan, who served as a delegate from Pennsylvania to the Second Continental Congress from 1777 to 1779 and signed the Articles of Confederation on behalf of the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania, contributing to the foundational governance of the emerging United States; and

WHEREAS, another branch of the family connects directly to Tennessee through Barry Clingan's great-great-great-grandfather, Edward Clingan, who was present in the area that would become Washington County as early as 1790; and

WHEREAS, Edward Clingan's son and Barry Clingan's great-great-grandfather, Alexander Adams Clingan, received an eighty-acre land grant from Tennessee Governor James C. Jones in March 1842 in Bradley County on land still known today as Clingan Ridge, where he is buried in the Clingan Family Cemetery; and

WHEREAS, a Tennessee historical marker at his gravesite recognizes Alexander Adams Clingan as the first sheriff of Bradley County; and

WHEREAS, Alexander Adams Clingan's wife, Martha Blythe Clingan, was the daughter of the founders of the historic Blythe Ferry on the Tennessee River, further rooting the family in early East Tennessee commerce and settlement; and

WHEREAS, Barry Clingan's great-grandfather, Elijah Edward Clingan, continued this legacy of public service by serving as the first sheriff of James County (now part of Hamilton County); and

WHEREAS, Barry Clingan was born in Hamilton County and has faithfully served as a pastor for more than forty years in churches across Tennessee, Georgia, Mississippi, and Texas, providing spiritual leadership and community guidance; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Clingan and his wife, Amy Thornburg Clingan, are the proud parents of four adult children, and he remains deeply thankful for his rich Scots-Irish East Tennessee lineage that embodies the pioneering spirit, faith, and resilience of early Tennesseans; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Barry Clingan upon his recognition by the East Tennessee Historical Association as a member of the First Families of Tennessee and for the distinguished heritage and lifelong service he represents.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.